

Apostates.

Described.

Deuteronomy 13:13. Certain men, the children of Belial, are gone out from among you, and have withdrawn the inhabitants of their city, saying, Let us go and serve other gods, which ye have not known;

Hebrews 3:12. Take heed, Brethren, lest there be in any of you an evil heart of unbelief, in departing from the living God.

Persecution tends to make.

Matthew 24:9-10. Then shall they deliver you up to be afflicted, and shall kill you: and ye shall be hated of all nations for my name's sake. And then shall many be offended, and shall betray one another, and shall hate one another.

A worldly spirit tends to make.

2 Timothy 4:10. For Demas hath forsaken me, having loved this present world, and is departed unto Thessalonica; Crescens to Galatia, Titus unto Dalmatia.

Never belonged to Christ.

1 John 2:19. They went out from us, but they were not of us; for if they had been of us, they would no doubt have continued with us: but they went out, that they might be made manifest that they were not all of us.

Saints do not become.

Psalms 44:18-19. Our heart is not turned back, neither have our steps declined from thy way; Though thou hast sore broken us in the place of dragons, and covered us with the shadow of Death.

That trust in the Law of Moses, impossible to restore.

Hebrews 6:4-6. For it is impossible for those who were once enlightened, and have tasted of the heavenly gift, and were made partakers of the Holy Ghost, And have tasted the good word

of God, and the powers of the world to come, If they shall fall away, to renew them again unto repentance; seeing they crucify to themselves the Son of God Afresh, and put him to an open shame.

Guilt and punishment of.

Zephaniah 1:4-6. I will also stretch out mine hand upon Judah, and upon all the inhabitants of Jerusalem; and I will cut off the remnant of Baal from this place, and the name of the Chemarims with the priests; And them that worship the host of heaven upon the housetops; and them that worship and that swear by the LORD, and that swear by Malcham; And them that are turned back from the LORD; and those that have not sought the LORD, nor inquired for him.

Hebrews 10:25-31. Not forsaking the assembling of ourselves together, as the manner of some is; but exhorting one another: and so much the more, as ye see the day approaching. For if we Sin wilfully after that we have received the knowledge of the truth, there remaineth no more sacrifice for Sins, But a certain fearful looking for of Judgment and fiery indignation, which shall devour the adversaries. He that despised Moses' law died without mercy under two or three witnesses: ...

Hebrews 10:39. But we are not of them who draw back unto perdition; but of them that believe to the saving of the soul.

2 Peter 2:17. These are wells without water, clouds that are carried with a tempest; to whom the mist of darkness is reserved for ever.

2 Peter 2:20-22. For if after they have escaped the pollutions of the world through the knowledge of the Lord and Saviour Jesus Christ, they are again entangled therein, and overcome, the latter end is worse with them than the beginning. For it had been better for them not to have known the way of righteousness, than, after they have known it, to turn from the holy commandment delivered unto them. But it is happened unto them according to the true proverb, The dog is turned to his own vomit again; and the sow that was washed to her wallowing in the mire.

Cautions against becoming.

Hebrews 3:12. Take heed, Brethren, lest there be in any of you an evil heart of unbelief, in

departing from the living God.

2 Peter 3:17. Ye therefore, beloved, seeing ye know these things before, beware lest ye also, being led Away with the error of the wicked, fall from your own stedfastness.

Shall abound in the latter days.

Matthew 24:12. And because iniquity shall abound, the love of many shall wax cold.

2 Thessalonians 2:3. Let no man deceive you by any means: for that day shall not come, except there come a falling away first, and that man of Sin be revealed, the son of perdition;

1 Timothy 4:1-3. Now the Spirit speaketh expressly, that in the latter times some shall depart from the Faith, giving heed to seducing spirits, and doctrines of devils; Speaking lies in hypocrisy; having their Conscience seared with a hot iron; Forbidding to marry, and commanding to abstain from meats, which God hath created to be received with thanksgiving of them which believe and know the truth.

Exemplified.

Amaziah.

2 Chronicles 25:14. Now it came to pass, after that Amaziah was come from the slaughter of the Edomites, that he brought the gods of the children of Seir, and set them up to be his gods, and bowed down himself before them, and burned incense unto them.

2 Chronicles 25:27. Now after the time that Amaziah did turn away from following the LORD they made a conspiracy against him in Jerusalem; and he fled to Lachish: but they sent to Lachish after him, and slew him there.

Professed disciples.

John 6:66. From that time many of his disciples went back, and walked no more with him.

Hymeneus and Alexander.

1 Timothy 1:19-20. Holding Faith, and a good Conscience; which some having put away concerning Faith have made shipwreck: Of whom is Hymenaeus and Alexander; whom I have delivered unto Satan, that they may learn not to blaspheme.